

Smart-Save Project Reflection and Team Summary Report

James Henson

April 30, 2026

Individual Reflection

I contributed primarily as the Frontend Architect while also assisting with backend development. My responsibilities included helping design and implement the React user interface, routing structure, dashboard views, forms for goals and transactions, and ensuring the frontend communicated correctly with backend API endpoints. I also supported backend tasks such as endpoint integration, debugging controller responses, and validating data flow between the client and server.

Testing and documentation were also important parts of my contribution. I helped verify that login, registration, dashboard retrieval, transaction creation, and goal management worked as expected. During development, I reviewed responses, fixed routing issues, and helped maintain organized documentation so the project remained understandable and scalable.

Our teamwork was effective because everybody in the team contributed and understood the deliverables. Each member had their own role in the structure and workflow of the application, which helped us divide tasks efficiently and remain accountable. Communication and shared responsibility allowed us to move through milestones with a clear direction.

Technically, this project helped me grow in full-stack development. I strengthened my understanding of React components, state management, REST API integration, authentication flows, backend architecture, and database persistence. I also gained more experience solving real development issues through debugging and iterative testing.

From an ethical and AI perspective, AI tools were used as builders, debuggers, and problem-solving assistants in areas of support. However, all generated suggestions still required human review, validation, and adaptation to meet project requirements. Responsible AI use means treating these tools as assistants rather than replacements for critical thinking, originality, and accountability.

Team Summary Report

Architecture and Features

Smart-Save is a full-stack personal finance tracker built with a React frontend and Spring Boot backend. The application uses Spring Security for session-based authentication and an H2 persistent database for storing users, goals, transactions, and exchange-rate snapshots. Features include user registration/login, dashboards, savings goal management, transaction tracking, protected routes, and public API integration for exchange rates.

Testing Summary

The team tested authentication workflows, protected endpoints, GET and POST requests, frontend routing, and database persistence. Controllers, service layers, repositories, and frontend API calls were reviewed to ensure stable communication and consistent JSON responses.

Future Improvements

Future enhancements could include budget forecasting, charts and analytics, mobile responsiveness improvements, email notifications, cloud database deployment, role-based admin features, and stronger automated unit/integration testing.

Team Roles and Acknowledgments

Lonzo Jones – Project Manager / Backend Developer

James Henson – Frontend Architect / Backend Developer

Isaiah Alfred – Endpoint Specialist / Backend Developer

The success of the project came from each team member contributing their skills and supporting one another throughout development.